

Mathematics

Year 5

Cambridge Primary
Student Manual



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British English edition.

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INTRODUCTION

How this book works

In this first unit you will read and write numbers up to a million, learn to round them sensibly, and use negative numbers in situations you actually meet.

How to help

- **Work together.** Read the page aloud, then let your child lead.
- **Talk lots.** The questions start conversations, they do not test.
- **Keep it fun.** Short, happy sessions beat long, tired ones.

A note for grown-ups

This book follows the spirit of an international primary programme, interpreted afresh for Prime School. Every unit grows new skills out of a topic children already care about, and finishes with something to make, draw or write.

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

Reading the page

Each section follows the same rhythm, so you always know where you are.

PANEL	WHAT IT DOES
In this unit, you will	The goals for the unit.
Let us start	A quick warm-up to wake up what you know.
Listening and speaking	Talk and listen about the topic.
Vocabulary	Learn new words, with pictures.
Remember!	A reminder of something you already learned.
Word book	Write down new words to keep.
Thinking time	A question to think and talk about.
I can	Statements to check your progress.

How to work

Take your time and look at the pictures: they are there to help you. When you see a new word, say it out loud. In Talking time there are no wrong answers, only good ideas.

GETTING READY

Before Unit 1

You do not need much: a pencil, some crayons, a notebook, and someone to work with.

Your toolkit

- Your eyes, for looking carefully at the pictures.
- Your voice, for reading out loud and sharing ideas.
- Your notebook, for writing and drawing what you find.

A little warm-up

- 1 What do you already know about this topic?
- 2 What would you most like to find out?
- 3 Who could you ask if you got stuck?

These are exactly the things Unit 1 will help you with. When you can answer them, you are ready to begin.

1

The number system

Big numbers, rounding and estimating

© IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Read and write numbers up to a million.
- ✓ Say what each digit is worth in a large number.
- ✓ Round numbers to the nearest 10, 100, 1000 and 10 000.
- ✓ Use negative numbers in real situations.

◆ LET US START

Lisbon has roughly half a million people living in the city itself. Write half a million in figures. Now add ten to it and write the answer in both figures and words.

UNIT 1 • PART 1

Place value to a million

In 345 678 the digit 3 is worth 300 000, the 4 is worth 40 000 and the 5 is worth 5000.

- 1 What is the value of the digit 7 in each number?
a. 670 346 b. 702 138 c. 275 000
- 2 Write these in figures:
a. one million
b. five hundred thousand and five
c. four hundred and three thousand
- 3 Write these in words: a. 345 678 b. 537 914

UNIT 1 • PART 2

Rounding and estimating

To **round** a number, look at the digit to the right of the place you are rounding to. If it is 5 or more, round up. If it is less than 5, round down.

🔄 REMEMBER!

345 678 rounded to the nearest 1000 is 346 000, because the hundreds digit is 6, which is 5 or more, so you round up.

- 1 Round 345 678 to the nearest: a. 1000 b. 10 000
- 2 Round 82 431 to the nearest: a. 100 b. 1000
- 3 A stadium holds 47 862 people. Round this to the nearest thousand to make it easier to remember.

- 4 Estimate $6120 + 3980$ by rounding each number to the nearest thousand first.

UNIT 1 • PART 3

Negative numbers in context

- 1 A lift starts on floor 3 and goes down 5 floors. Which floor does it reach?
- 2 Put these in order, lowest first: -12 , 5 , -3 , 0 .
- 3 The temperature falls from 4°C to -2°C . How many degrees did it fall?

◆ THINKING TIME

When is an estimate more useful than an exact answer? Give a real example.

☑ SUMMARY CHECKLIST

- ✓ I can read and write numbers up to a million.
- ✓ I can say what each digit is worth.
- ✓ I can round numbers to a given place.
- ✓ I can use negative numbers in real situations.

UNIT 1 • FINAL PROJECT

The population poster

★ FINAL PROJECT

The population poster

Research the real populations of six Portuguese cities or towns. Present them on a poster, each written in figures and in words, and each rounded sensibly.

What to hand in

- Six real populations, in figures and in words.
- Each one rounded to the nearest thousand and ten thousand.
- A note on why rounding makes the poster easier to read.

How it will be judged

Criterion	Weight	--- ---	Accuracy of figures	35%	Correct rounding	35%	Clarity of presentation	20%	The explanatory note	10%
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UNIT 1 • CHECK YOUR PROGRESS

- 1 What is the value of the digit 7 in 670 346?
- 2 Write five hundred thousand and five in figures.
- 3 Round 345 678 to the nearest 1000.
- 4 Round 345 678 to the nearest 10 000.
- 5 A lift starts on floor 3 and goes down 5 floors. Which floor is it on?
- 6 Estimate $6120 + 3980$ by rounding first.

UNIT 1 • EVALUATION

Be honest. Colour the circle that matches how you feel about each outcome: green means confident, amber means nearly there, red means needs more work.

I CAN ...	GREEN	AMBER	RED
read and write numbers up to a million	☐	☐	☐
say what each digit is worth	☐	☐	☐
round numbers to a given place	☐	☐	☐
use negative numbers in real situations	☐	☐	☐

UNIT 1 • WHAT CAN YOU DO?

✓ WHAT CAN YOU DO?

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Read and write numbers up to a million. | ☐ Round numbers to a given place. |
| ☐ Say what each digit is worth. | ☐ Use negative numbers in real situations. |

GLOSSARY

Unit 1

round: to change a number to a nearby, simpler one.

estimate: a sensible approximate answer.

place value: what a digit is worth because of its position.

million: one thousand thousands.

SOURCES & REFERENCES

Where everything came from

All text and diagrams are original to this edition. The factual claims can be checked here. Links were live as of July 2026.

- 1 **Rounding and estimation.** The methods here follow standard primary-number practice.

Big numbers, handled with confidence.

This Year 5 Student Book scales up. You will read and write numbers to a million, round them to any place, estimate quickly, and use negative numbers in real situations.

Written for Prime School pupils, in clear British English, with every answer checked by computer.

MILLIONS

ROUNDING

ESTIMATING

NEGATIVES